

Alabama Learning Hour

Introduce Yourself! Patient Verbs and *-o/-bi*

October 8th, 2026

1 *Amoklaha* Text

Amoklaha

My Friends

Ava: Chaholchifaya Ava. Chiholchifak naasolĩ?

Jacob: Chaholchifaya Jacob.

Ava: Chikaanõ?

Jacob: Chakaanobi. Isnã?

Ava: Chakaanobi. Achayokpo.

Tanya: Hachikaano. Chaholchifaya Tanya. Hachiholchifaya naasolĩ?

Ava: Poholchifaya Ava, Jacob.

Tanya: Hachikaanõ?

Ava: Pokaanobi. Apoyokpo.

My Friends - English Translation

Ava: My name is Ava. What is your name?

Jacob: My name is Jacob.

Ava: How are you?

Jacob: I am good. You?

Ava: I am good. I'm happy.

Tanya: Hello y'all. My name is Tanya. What are y'all's names?

Ava: Our names are Ava and Jacob.

Tanya: How are y'all?

Ava: We are good. We are happy.

2 Vocabulary

New Words from the Dialogue

holchifa	name
cha holchifa	my name
chi holchifa	your name
po holchifa / ko holchifa	our names
hachi holchifa	y'all's names
kaano	to be good
ayokpa	to be happy

Talking about states

hoyapli	to be tired	nochiila	to be sleepy
hoopa	to be sick	maɫatli	to be scared
ilapalaali	to be angry	kayya	to be full (not hungry)
chaaha	to be tall	chakiiho	to be short

3 Introducing yourself

Today we will learn some formulas for introducing yourself and making basic greetings in Alabama.

Introduction Easy Recipe: Saying “Hi” to one person

Q: *How are you?*

- (1) [**Chi** + **kaanõ**]? → *Chikaanõ?*
[**you** + **good.Question**]
'How are you?'

A: *I'm good.*

- (2) [**Cha** + **kaano** + **bi**] → *Chakaanobi*
I + **good** + **STATE**
'I'm good.'

Introduction Easy Recipe: Saying “Hi” to multiple person

Q: *How are you?*

- (3) [Hachi + kaanō] ? → Hachikaanō?
[y'all + good.Question]
'How are y'all?'

A: *I'm good.*

- (4) [Po-/Ko- + kaano] + bi] → Pokaanobi/Kokaanobi
we + good + STATE
'We're good.'

Making Friends Easy Recipe

Q: *What is your name?*

- (5) [Chi + holchifa + k] [naasi + oolī] ? → Chiholchifak naasooli?
[your + name + k] [what + it.is]
'What is your name?'

A: *My name is ____.*

- (6) [Cha + holchifa + ya] ____ → Chaholchifaya ____.
my + name + ya
'My name is ____'

Saying Farewell Easy Recipe

- (7) [Chi + hiichaa + lo] ! → Chihichaalo!
[you + I'll see + later]
'See you later!'

- Now you try! With a partner, say hello, introduce yourself, and say good-bye.

4 -O/-Bi Review: Talking about states

- A few weeks ago, we talked about a special suffix **-o** and its alternate form **-bi** that told us that someone was in a specific **state**.

(8) Ava-k kaano-**bi**
Ava-[subject] good-state
‘Ava is (in the state of being) good’

(9) Ava-k hoyapl-**o**
Ava-[subject] tired-state
‘Ava is (in the state of being) tired’

- Let’s revisit the rules for how to talk about what state someone is in:

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe (Stative O/BI, Statement)

If the verb ends on the vowel *-o* (e.g. *kaano*), this tense is *-bi*.

(10) [**Patient** + **k**] [**Verb** + **Tense**]
 [**Ava** + **k**] [**kaano** + **bi**]
 Ava good STATE
 Meaning: ‘Ava is good.’

If the verb does not end on *-o*, this tense will be *-o*. The vowel before it will disappear: *hoopa* → *hoop-o*, *hoyap.li* → *hoyap.l-o*.

(11) [**Patient** + **k**] [**Verb** + **Tense**]
 [**Ava** + **k**] [**hoyapl** + **o**]
 Ava tired STATE
 Meaning: ‘Ava is tired.’

- The *-o/bi tense*, which we might call a stative tense, describes different kinds of states that individuals can be in.
- With verbs like *kaano* ‘be good’, *hoopa* ‘be sick’, *hoyapli* ‘be tired’, it describes currently ongoing states.

- With verbs that describe non-stative events, e.g. *dancing*, or *opening*, the sentences have a different meaning. We'll revisit this at another day. Today we will focus on verbs that describe states like 'being tired', 'being healthy', or even 'being tall'
- O/bi forms are statements. To form a corresponding question, we simply drop this tense and add nasalization:

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe (Stative O/BI, Question)

(12) [Patient + k] [Verb.Tense]
 [Ava + k] [hoyapli]?
 Ava tired(question)
Meaning: 'Is Ava tired?'

Let's practice! Ask your classmate about their friend.

Answer using some of the verbs below.

(13) [Ava + k] [_____ĩ]?
 Ava _____
Meaning: 'Is Ava _____?'

(14) Ay, [Ava + k] [_____ -o/-bi]?
 Yes Ava _____
Meaning: 'Yes, Ava is _____?'

Examples of Alabama Patient Verbs expressing Feelings

hoyapli	to be tired	nochiila	to be sleepy
hoopa	to be sick	małatli	to be scared
ilapalaali	to be angry	kayya	to be full (not hungry)
chaaha	to be tall	chakiiho	to be short
ayokpa	to be happy	kaano	to be good

5 Patient Verbs

This lesson we will learn how to use what are called *patient* verbs. What is a patient verb?

Patient Verbs describe states of being, and actions which happen accidentally or without the subject's intention. The subject *undergoes* an action.

Patient Verbs that describe states of being

- **kaano** 'to be good'
- **chaaha** 'to be tall'
- **ayokpa** 'to be happy'
- **hoyapli** 'to be tired'
- With all of these verbs, the argument is a passive undergoer of the situation described by the verb—the action/event/situation just happens to them, *they don't have a say!*

Today, we will learn how to talk about how *you* or *me* feel.

- In the past couple of weeks we have learned how to talk about what happens when someone else is the *subject* of the sentence
- For example: Avak bitli-hchi 'Ava is dancing.'
- But when we want to talk about ourselves, or the person/people we are talking to, the verb needs to change in Alabama.
- English does this too! Consider:

(15) I **am** happy. (16) You **are** happy. (17) Ava **is** happy.

- But not:

(18) *I **is** happy. (19) *You **am** happy. (20) *Ava **are** happy.

Patient Verb Sentence Easy Recipe (Past, Statement)

- (21) [Patient + k] [Patient + Verb + Tense]
[ano + k] [cha- + hoyapl + o]
I I tired STATE
Meaning: 'I'm tired.'

- Today we will learn two *patient prefixes*; these *have* to go on verbs if we are talking about **me** or **you**.

Patient Morphemes:

- (22) 1st person singular — **I/me** (23) 2nd person singular — **You**
cha- **chi-**
Example: **cha-kaano-bi** 'I'm good.' Example: **chi-kaanõ** 'Are you ok?'

★ **Remember!** We don't add any patient prefix if we are talking about someone else, like 'Ava'.

★ In Alabama, you can optionally say a full *pronoun* to emphasize that *you too* do some action. Some pronouns in Alabama are:

- (24) 1st person singular — **I/me** (25) 2nd person singular — **You**
ano-k **ano-n** **isno-k** **isno-n**
(subject) (object) (subject) (object)

★ **CAREFUL!** If a verb begins with a vowel, the patient morpheme will do something special:

- Words beginning with **i-** will delete the **i**!
ilapalaali 'to be angry' → *cha-lapalaal-o* 'I'm angry'
- Words beginning with **a-** or **o-** will delete their first vowel, and put an **a-** before the patient marker.
ayokpa 'to be happy' → *a-cha-yokp-o* 'I'm happy'

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

EX: *kaano* ‘to be good’

- (26) a. **(anok) cha**-kaano-**bi**
I am good.
b. **(isnok) chi**-kaano-**bi**
You are good.
c. **(Avak)** kaano-**bi**
Ava is good.
-

nochiila ‘to be sleepy’

- (27) a. I am sleepy.
b. You are sleepy.
c. Ava is sleepy.

hoyapli ‘to be tired’

- (28) a. I am tired.
b. You are tired.
c. Ava is tired.

maɬatli ‘to be scared’

- (29) a. I am scared
b. You are scared
c. Ava is scared

hoopa ‘to be sick’

- (30) a. I am sick.
b. You are sick.
c. Ava is sick.

ilapalaali ‘to be angry’

★This word begins in a vowel!

- (31) a. I am angry.
b. You are angry.
c. Ava is angry.

ayokpa ‘to be happy’

★This word begins in a vowel!

- (32) a. I am happy.
b. You are happy.
c. Ava is happy.

Grammar Practice: How are you?

- **Let's Practice!** With a partner, talk about how someone is feeling. Replace Ex1 with the verb on the left, and Ex2 with the verb on the right.

• New Words: 'Mahmin' — but Chifoni — 'Your sister'

A: Chifoni kaanõ?

A: How is your sister?

B: Kaanobi/Kankobi. [Ex1: hoop]-o.

B: Good/Not good. She is sick.

A: Mahmin, chikaanõ? [Ex2: chi-nochiilã]?

A: But, how are you? Are you [Ex2: sleepy]?

B: Ay, [cha-nochiil]-o.

B: Yes, I'm sleepy.

1. Example: (1) hoopa — sick, (2) nochiila — sleepy
2. kaano — good, hoopa — sick
3. nochihla — sleepy, falanka — awake
4. kaano — good, maɫatli — scared
5. nokhammi — angry, ayokpa — happy
6. Choose your own!